

AI Prompts for Learning & Code Understanding

Three prompts you can reuse

These are prompt templates for using an AI assistant while learning to code. Replace the text in <angle brackets> with your own context.

1. Explain code line by line

Explain the following <language> code line by line, as if I am a beginner. Point out anything that could be a bug or a bad practice, and suggest one improvement.

<paste your code here>

When to use: Great when you inherit code you didn't write, or don't understand a snippet from a tutorial.

2. Learn a concept with an example

I'm learning <concept, e.g. REST APIs>. Explain it in simple terms in under 150 words, give one small real-world analogy, and then show one short code example I can run.

When to use: Good for building a mental model quickly before going deeper.

3. Debug with reasoning, not just a fix

Here is my code and the error I get. Don't just fix it – first explain what is causing the error, then show the corrected code, then tell me how to avoid this class of error in future.

Code:
<code>

Error:
<error message>

When to use: Turns debugging into learning, so you don't hit the same problem again.